

AGENCY CONTENT STRATEGY

Standard Operating Procedure

Short-Form & Long-Form Content to Attract Ecom Brands & Service Businesses

PRIMARY FOCUS Short-Form (Reels & Stories)	SECONDARY FOCUS Long-Form (YouTube)	ICP Ecom + Service Brands
---	--	------------------------------

SECTION 1: Content Philosophy & Positioning

1.1 The Core Content Mission

Every piece of content you post should answer one question in the viewer's mind: "Why should I trust this agency with my brand?" The answer is not a pitch — it's proof. It's education. It's results. It's personality.

This SOP is built around one non-negotiable principle:

Give away so much value that following you becomes a business decision, not just entertainment. Your content should make prospects feel like they already work with you before they ever reach out.

1.2 Content Pillars (The 5 Buckets)

Every post, Reel, or video must belong to one of five content pillars. This keeps your feed strategic and attracts both ecom and service-based clients.

Pillar	What It Covers	ICP It Attracts
01 PROOF	Case studies, results, screenshots, revenue uplift, before/after	Both Ecom + Service
02 EDUCATION	Tactics, how-tos, frameworks, industry breakdowns	Both Ecom + Service
03 PROCESS	Behind-the-scenes of how you work, build, deliver	Service-based + Agency
04 OPINION	Hot takes, industry myths, contrarian views, trends	Both — attracts attention

05 CULTURE	Your team, your wins, your story, your day-to-day	Service-based primarily
---------------	---	-------------------------

1.3 ICP-Specific Content Angles

For Ecom Brands, lead with:

- ROAS improvements, cost per purchase drops, revenue from paid + organic
- Email/SMS open rates, abandoned cart recovery stats
- Product launch strategies, creative testing frameworks
- Store conversion rate optimization
- Real client ad creatives (with permission) and breakdowns

For Service-Based Businesses, lead with:

- Lead generation — cost per lead, booked call rates
- Funnel walk-throughs — how you build their client pipeline
- Automations that save them time (bookings, follow-ups, reviews)
- Local SEO, Google profile optimization wins
- Authority + trust building strategies that close premium clients

SECTION 2: Short-Form Content SOP (Primary Focus)

Short-form is your #1 client acquisition channel. Instagram Reels and Facebook Reels get distributed to non-followers — meaning every post is an outreach. Treat every Reel like a cold DM that reaches 10,000 people.

2.1 Platforms & Posting Schedule

Platform	Reels / Week	Stories / Day	Carousels / Week	Total Weekly Posts
Instagram	4–5	1–2	1–2	7–10
Facebook	3–4	1	0–1	4–6
TikTok (optional)	3–4	—	—	3–4

Total short-form output target: 10–15 pieces of content per week across platforms.

2.2 The Reel Framework (Hook → Value → CTA)

Every Reel must follow this 3-part structure. No exceptions.

PART 1: THE HOOK (0–3 seconds)

Your hook is everything. If the first 3 seconds don't stop the scroll, nothing else matters.

Hook Formula Options:

- A) RESULT HOOK: 'This ecom brand went from \$18k/mo to \$94k/mo in 90 days. Here's how.'
- B) MYTH BUST: 'Stop boosting posts. Here's what actually grows service businesses.'
- C) LISTICLE: '5 things your agency should be doing for your Google reviews (but isn't)'
- D) CURIOSITY: 'The ad strategy nobody talks about — and it has a 4.2x ROAS floor.'
- E) DIRECT CALL: 'If you run an ecom store and you're not doing this, you're leaving money.'

PART 2: THE VALUE BODY (3–45 seconds)

Deliver the actual insight. No fluff. Think: what would a paid consultant say here?

Frameworks that work:

- Step-by-step breakdown (numbered = easy to follow on screen)
- Before vs. After (show the transformation visually or verbally)
- Teardown (audit a real ad, funnel, or strategy — even your own)
- Screen-share (show inside your ad account, CRM, analytics tool)
- Talking head + text overlay (speak directly, bullet points appear as you talk)

Rule: Say ONE thing well. Don't cram 5 lessons into 30 seconds.

PART 3: THE CTA (Last 3–5 seconds)

Never end a Reel without a call to action. Pick ONE per video:

- SOFT CTA (Build audience): 'Follow for more — I post this stuff daily.'
- ENGAGEMENT CTA: 'Comment [AUDIT] and I'll review your funnel for free.'
- DM CTA: 'DM me the word [RESULTS] and I'll send you the full framework.'
- LINK CTA: 'Link in bio to book a free strategy call.'

Rotate CTA types weekly. Don't use the same CTA on every video — you train your audience to ignore it.

2.3 Reel Content Categories & Weekly Mix

Use this as your weekly content calendar template. Repeat the cycle each week.

Day	Format	Topic Example	Pillar
Mon	Reel (60s)	'The exact 3-ad creative types we use for ecom cold traffic'	EDUCATION
Tue	Story/Poll	Quick poll: 'Biggest growth challenge?' + share a tip	CULTURE
Wed	Reel (30s)	Client result: 'From 12 leads/mo to 47 — here's the change we made'	PROOF
Thu	Carousel	'5 mistakes service businesses make with their Google profile'	EDUCATION
Fri	Reel (45s)	Hot take: 'Agencies that promise guaranteed results are lying to you'	OPINION
Sat	Reel (30s)	BTS: 'How we built an automated lead system for a law firm in 4 days'	PROCESS
Sun	Story	Client win share + re-share of best performing post from the week	PROOF

2.4 Short-Form Production Standards

Video Specs:

- Format: 9:16 vertical (1080 x 1920px) — always
- Length: 15–60s for Reels (sweet spot is 30–45s)
- Captions: Always add auto-captions — 85% of viewers watch without sound
- Thumbnail: Custom still frame or text graphic — never auto-selected
- Hook text on screen: First 3 seconds must have text overlay reinforcing the spoken hook

Audio:

- Use trending audio if content allows — Instagram boosts Reels using trending sounds
- For talking-head / educational content: your voice IS the audio, no music needed
- Add subtle background music at -20dB under voiceover for polish

Editing Style by Content Type:

Content Type	Editing Approach
Talking Head / Tip	Fast cuts every 2–3s, text popups, b-roll inserts, captions bold + large
Client Case Study	Start with result stat, show proof screenshot, explain steps, end w/ CTA

Screen Share / Tutorial	Zoom highlights on key areas, cursor tracking, voiceover explanation
Hot Take / Opinion	Single shot or minimal cuts, intensity in tone, strong hook text, bold caption
BTS / Process	Montage style, upbeat music, text captions explaining what's happening

2.5 Instagram Stories SOP

Stories are your relationship layer. Reels attract new followers; Stories convert them into warm leads.

Daily Stories Framework (1–3 per day):

- Morning: Share a quick insight, tip, or question poll (builds habit of viewing)
- Midday (optional): Repurpose Reel as story, or share a client win screenshot
- Evening: Behind-the-scenes moment, team photo, or 'question box' to invite DMs

High-Converting Story Types:

Story Type	Why It Works
Poll: 'Do you do X?'	Drives engagement + segments audience by pain point
Question Box: 'Ask me anything'	Fills your DMs — you respond = direct relationship
Result Screenshot + context	Pure social proof in 15 seconds
'This or That' swipe	Easy interaction, trains algorithm to show your content
Link sticker to booking page	Converts warm audience — use after 3+ value stories
'Working on this for a client...' tease	Creates curiosity, encourages DMs

2.6 Carousel Post SOP

Carousels are the highest-save format on Instagram. Saves = algorithm gold. Use them for deep-dives, frameworks, and list content.

Carousel Structure (7–12 slides):

1. Slide 1: Hook slide — Bold statement or result (this is your thumbnail, make it stop-scroll)
2. Slide 2: Why this matters — set the problem/context
3. Slides 3–9: One insight per slide. Short sentences. Big text. Easy to swipe.
4. Slide 10: Recap / Summary ("Save this for later")
5. Slide 11: CTA slide — Follow, DM, book a call, comment

Best Carousel Topics for the ICP:

- '7 reasons your ecom store isn't converting (and how to fix each one)'

- 'The 5-email welcome sequence that generates 22% of our clients' total revenue'
- 'How we build a lead gen system for service businesses in 7 days'
- 'Facebook Ads audit: 8 things we check before touching a client's account'
- 'The Google Business Profile checklist every service business needs'

2.7 Short-Form Caption Formula

Captions are often ignored — which means if you write great ones, you stand out.

THE 4-PART CAPTION FORMULA
LINE 1 (Hook): Expand on the video hook or add a new angle — this shows above the fold.
Example: 'Most ecom brands are one email sequence away from an extra \$15k/month.'
LINES 2–4 (Context/Value): 2–3 short punchy lines adding depth. No paragraphs.
Example: 'The problem isn't traffic. It's not even the product.'
'It's what happens after someone adds to cart and doesn't buy.'
'Abandoned cart sequences fix that — and most brands have none.'
CTA LINE: Specific and action-oriented.
Example: 'Comment CART below and I'll send you the exact 3-email sequence we use.'
HASHTAGS (5–10): Mix of niche-specific and broad. Don't use 30 generic tags.
Example: #ecommercemarketing #dropshipping #emailmarketing #shopifytips #digitalagency

SECTION 3: Long-Form Content SOP (YouTube)

YouTube is your long-game authority builder. One great YouTube video can bring in qualified leads for 3 years. Short-form gets attention; YouTube gets trust. Together, they close deals.

3.1 YouTube Posting Cadence

- Target: 1 video per week (minimum 1 per 10 days to maintain growth)
- Length: 8–20 minutes (sweet spot is 10–14 min for educational content)
- Upload day: Tuesday or Wednesday (historically highest CTR for B2B content)
- Shorts on YouTube: Repurpose your best Instagram Reels (same file, different platform)

3.2 YouTube Video Categories (Rotate Monthly)

Video Type	Description	Example Title
Deep-Dive Tutorial	Step-by-step execution of one tactic	'How to Build a Facebook Lead Gen Funnel for Service Businesses (Full Walkthrough)'
Case Study	Real client results with full breakdown	'How We 3x'd an Ecom Brand's Revenue in 60 Days (Ad Strategy Inside)'
Agency BTS	Your process, systems, team, tools	'A Week in My Agency: How We Manage 12 Clients Without Burning Out'
Reaction / Audit	Live audit of someone's ads, site, or funnel	'I Audited a Service Business Facebook Page — Here's Everything Wrong'
Industry Myth Bust	Contrarian takes backed by data	'Why Most Agencies Fail Their Ecom Clients (The Truth Nobody Says)'
Q&A / Mailbag	Answer real questions from audience/clients	'You Asked, I Answered: Agency Owner Q&A (Pricing, Clients, Growth)'

3.3 YouTube Video Structure (The 5-Act Formula)

ACT 1 — HOOK (0:00–0:45)
Open with the result or promise. Tell them exactly what they will learn.
Do NOT start with an intro about yourself. That comes later.
Formula: '[State the outcome they'll get] — in this video I'm going to show you exactly how [client/you/strategy] achieved [result] and you can do the same.'
Example: 'This ecom store was spending \$8,000 a month on ads with a 1.4x ROAS.
By changing three things — just three — we got them to 3.8x in 6 weeks.
I'm going to break down exactly what we changed and why, step by step.'
ACT 2 — CREDIBILITY BRIDGE (0:45–1:30)
Now introduce yourself — briefly. 30 seconds max.
'I'm [Name], I run [Agency Name]. We've worked with X clients in [niche].'
Then ask for the subscribe: 'If you want weekly [niche] marketing strategies, subscribe now.'

ACT 3 — CONTEXT / PROBLEM SETUP (1:30–3:00)

Set the stage. Explain the problem your ICP faces before you give the solution.

This is where you demonstrate deep understanding of their world.

For ecom: 'Most Shopify brands over-index on acquisition and ignore retention.

The result? CAC climbs, ROAS drops, and the whole thing becomes unprofitable.'

For service: 'Service businesses get 60–70% of their leads from referrals.

That feels great until referrals dry up. Then there's nothing in the pipeline.'

ACT 4 — THE MEAT (3:00 to end – 2:00)

Deliver the actual content. Numbered steps, frameworks, screen shares, case studies.

This should be the longest section — where you give genuine, implementable value.

Rules for the Meat:

- Use chapters/timestamps (YouTube rewards this with better search placement)
- Show, don't just tell — screen shares, mockups, dashboards, real examples
- Reference your ICP's specific pain throughout: 'If you're running a service biz...'
- Plant curiosity loops: 'The last step is the one most people skip — hold on.'

ACT 5 — CTA CLOSE (Last 60–90 seconds)

End with ONE primary CTA and reinforce the value they just received.

Sequence:

1. Summary: 'So in this video we covered X, Y, Z...'
2. Soft pitch: 'If you want us to do this for your business, link is in the description.'
3. Subscribe ask: 'I post this kind of breakdown every week — subscribe so you don't miss it.'
4. Tease next video: 'Next week I'm breaking down [topic] — that video alone could double your [result].'

3.4 YouTube SEO Basics

- Title: Lead with the keyword + include a result or number. 60 chars max.
- Thumbnail: Bold text (3–5 words max), high-contrast colors, face or visual proof
- Description: First 2 lines are the hook (show before 'more' fold) + timestamps + links
- Tags: 5–10 specific + 3–5 broad (e.g. 'facebook ads for ecom' + 'digital marketing')
- Chapters: Add timestamps at every major section — boosts watch time and search rank
- Pinned Comment: Add a comment with your CTA immediately after publishing

SECTION 4: The Content Repurposing Engine

One YouTube video = 10+ pieces of content. One deep Reel = 3+ repurposed assets. Build once, distribute everywhere. This is how solo creators and small teams compete with large content teams.

4.1 Repurposing Map

Source Content	What You Repurpose It Into
1 YouTube Video (10–15 min)	3–5 Reels (pull best 30–60s moments), 1–2 Carousels (pull key framework), 5–7 Story slides, 1 LinkedIn article or post, 3 tweet threads (optional), 1 email newsletter
1 Instagram Reel	Facebook Reel (same file), YouTube Short (same file), Story (clip or screenshot), 1 caption-driven carousel if topic is expandable
1 Client Case Study	1 Reel (result hook + 3 steps), 1 Carousel (before/after breakdown), 1 YouTube deep-dive, 2 Stories (proof screenshot + 'how we did it' teaser)
1 Carousel Post	2 Story slides (pull top 2 frames), 1 Reel script (narrate the slides), Pin as a highlight

4.2 Weekly Content Production Workflow

Day	Task	Details
Monday	Planning + Scripting	Choose this week's content themes, write scripts/outlines for all Reels + YouTube video
Tuesday	Batch Filming	Film all talking-head Reels in one session. Film YouTube video.
Wednesday	Editing	Edit Reels, YouTube, carousels. Add captions, thumbnails.
Thursday	Scheduling	Schedule all Reels + carousels via Meta Business Suite or Later. Upload YouTube.
Friday	Engagement Sprint	Reply to every comment within 24h. Answer DMs. Check analytics.
Sat–Sun	Repurposing	Turn YouTube into Reels/clips for next week's pipeline. Stories only.

SECTION 5: 60 Plug-and-Play Content Ideas

Use this as your content idea bank. These are proven topic angles that attract ecom brands and service businesses. Customize with your own results, client stories, and opinions.

5.1 Short-Form Reel Ideas — Ecom Focus

- 'The exact email subject lines that get 40%+ open rates for ecom brands'
- 'Why we paused a client's best-performing ad — and ROAS went up'
- 'Your product page is killing your conversion rate. Here's what to fix first.'
- 'The 3-campaign Facebook structure every ecom store should run'
- 'This one post-purchase email made our client \$11k last month'
- 'Stop using broad audiences on cold traffic. Here's why + what to do instead.'
- 'Ecom brand went from 1.8x to 4.1x ROAS — the 4 changes we made'
- 'The abandoned cart sequence that recovers 18% of lost sales (template inside)'
- 'Why your creative isn't the problem (and what actually is)'
- 'We A/B tested 6 ad hooks for an apparel brand — here's what won'

5.2 Short-Form Reel Ideas — Service Business Focus

- 'We got a plumbing company 41 leads in 30 days. Here's the exact funnel.'
- 'The Google Business Profile tweak that 3x'd a client's calls in 2 weeks'
- 'Why most service businesses lose 60% of their leads in the first hour'
- 'The 5-touch automated follow-up sequence that books more calls without lifting a finger'
- 'Stop running Facebook lead gen forms. Use this instead.'
- 'How a med-spa went from 8 to 34 Google reviews in 6 weeks'
- 'The landing page formula that converts cold traffic for service businesses'
- 'Why your service business doesn't need more leads — you need better follow-up'
- 'We audited 50 service business websites. 80% had this same fatal flaw.'
- 'The exact intake form question that doubled our client's close rate'

5.3 Authority & Opinion Reels (Works for Both ICPs)

- 'The agency red flags nobody talks about (thread)'
- 'Honest take: why 6-month contracts are bad for you as a client'
- '3 things I wish I knew before starting a marketing agency'
- 'Why vanity metrics are destroying your marketing strategy'
- 'The real reason most agency-client relationships fail after 90 days'
- 'What I'd do with a \$1,000/month marketing budget as a small service business'
- 'Unpopular opinion: your niche doesn't matter as much as your offer'
- 'Stop outsourcing things you don't understand'

5.4 YouTube Long-Form Ideas

- 'Full Facebook Ads Setup for Service Businesses in 2025 (Step-by-Step)'
- 'How We Run a Shopify Brand's Email Marketing from \$0 to \$40k/Month (Case Study)'
- 'Building a Lead Machine for Local Businesses: Complete Walkthrough'
- 'Agency Pricing Masterclass: How to Price, Package, and Present Your Services'
- 'The Truth About Working With an Agency (From the Agency Side)'
- 'A Month in My Agency: Revenue, Clients, Wins, and Losses'
- 'Ecom Facebook Ads in 2025: What's Working and What's Dead'
- 'How to Get Your First 10 Clients as a Marketing Agency'
- 'Live Ad Account Audit: Breaking Down a \$20k/Month Ecom Brand'
- 'The 7-Day Client Onboarding Process That Sets Up Every Engagement for Success'

SECTION 6: Converting Content Into Client Conversations

Content without a conversion strategy is just entertainment. Every week you post, you should be actively converting warm viewers into discovery calls. Here's how.

6.1 The Comment-to-DM System

Run this on your top 1–2 Reels per week. It is your highest-ROI short-form strategy.

STEP 1 — CTA IN VIDEO
At the end of the Reel, say:
'Comment [keyword] below and I'll send you [specific deliverable] directly.'
Examples:
'Comment FUNNEL and I'll send you our full ecom funnel template.'
'Comment AUDIT and I'll send you a free 5-point marketing audit for your business.'
'Comment LEADS and I'll send you the exact follow-up sequence we use for service clients.'
STEP 2 — DM FOLLOW-UP SCRIPT (Within 2 Hours)
Hey [Name]! Saw your comment on the [topic] video — sending the [deliverable] now.
[Send the value piece — PDF, template, framework, etc.]
Out of curiosity — what does your current [marketing/funnel/ad setup] look like right now?

Trying to make sure what I send is actually useful for where you're at.

STEP 3 — QUALIFY AND PITCH THE CALL

If they respond positively and describe their situation, pivot to a call:

'That makes sense — honestly it sounds like there's a pretty clear path to [result].

Would it be worth jumping on a quick 20-min call this week? I can pull up your

[ads/funnel/profile] live and show you exactly what I'd change.

No pitch, no pressure — just want to see if it's something we could actually help with.'

6.2 Profile Optimization for Conversion

Your profile is a landing page. Warm leads will visit it before they DM you. Make sure it converts.

Instagram Bio Formula:

- Line 1: Who you help + what outcome — 'We grow ecom brands & service businesses'
- Line 2: Credibility anchor — '\$X revenue generated | X clients served'
- Line 3: CTA — 'Book a free strategy call 📞'
- Link: Use a Linktree or single landing page — not your agency website homepage

Highlights to Have:

- RESULTS — Case studies, screenshots, revenue stats
- HOW WE WORK — Quick overview of your process
- CLIENT LOVE — Testimonials, DMs, reviews
- FREE STUFF — Link to a lead magnet or freebie

6.3 Content KPIs to Track Weekly

Metric	Where to Track	Target
Reel Reach (non-followers)	Instagram Insights	50%+ of total reach from non-followers
Reel Save Rate	Instagram Insights	>2% of views = saves
Profile Visits per Week	Instagram Insights	Growing week-over-week
New Followers from Reels	Instagram Insights	>30% of new follows from Reels
DMs from Content	Manual count	5+ qualified DMs per week
Calls Booked from Content	CRM	2–5 per week at scale

YouTube Watch Time	YouTube Studio	Growing month-over-month
YouTube CTR	YouTube Studio	>5% average across channel

SECTION 7: Content Rules & Standards

7.1 The 10 Non-Negotiable Content Rules

- 6. Never post without a hook. If the first 3 seconds don't hook, don't post it.
- 7. One idea per video. Complexity kills short-form. Narrow = shareable.
- 8. Show proof as often as possible. Claims without proof are just ads.
- 9. Post consistently over perfectly. 3 good Reels/week beats 1 perfect Reel/month.
- 10. Engage within the first 60 minutes. Reply to comments fast — the algorithm rewards it.
- 11. Never hard sell in content. The content builds trust; the DM closes the call.
- 12. Use your ICP's language. Say 'leads' not 'conversions'. Say 'revenue' not 'MRR'.
- 13. Always add captions. 85% of Reels are watched on silent.
- 14. Track what works. If a Reel hits 3x your average reach — make 3 more like it.
- 15. Give before you ask. For every CTA-heavy post, do 3 pure-value posts.

7.2 Content Mistakes to Avoid

- Posting only 'about us' / agency updates — nobody cares until you've proven value
- Using jargon your client doesn't understand (CPM, ROAS without explaining it)
- Selling too early — content builds trust over weeks, not in one post
- Inconsistent posting — going 2 weeks silent kills your algorithm momentum
- Making every video about yourself instead of your client's transformation
- Ignoring comments — engagement on comments drives reach as much as new posts
- Posting the same CTA every single time — rotate and test

Content is compounding. The Reel you post today might bring in a client 8 months from now. The YouTube video you make this week might rank for 3 years. Plant seeds consistently and the pipeline fills itself.